

OG Josh — Operational Dossier

Parallel timeline. Single. 92 Lakeside Circuit, Dubbo NSW. Saturday 2 May 2026.

Identity

Josh Parris. 36. Never married, no kids. Moved to Dubbo from Bendigo in 2017 for a junior policy role and never left. Drives a 2022 Ford Ranger XLT (fully maintained as part of his package — kept tidy, nothing on the dash). Owns one cat: ****Bast****, four-year-old grey tabby, RSPCA rescue, indoor-mostly, sleeps on the rumpus couch by day and the foot of the bed by night. Tolerates guests; ignores most of them.

Faith is still core but quieter than family-Josh's — has to be chosen weekly with no family rhythm carrying it. Attends Dubbo Presbyterian most Sundays at 10am, doesn't always make it. Bible and journal in the morning with coffee. ADHD same as real Josh; anxiety load is lower (no marriage/kid stressors), but loneliness is the trade.

Work

****Role:**** Senior Stakeholder Engagement Coordinator – Western NSW Region, Department of Regional NSW. Started early 2024.

****Package:****

- Base \$145,000
- Super 12% = \$17,400
- Fully maintained Ford Ranger XLT
- Phone/laptop allowance ~\$2,400/yr
- ****Total package value ~\$170k****

****Take-home:**** ~\$8,800/month after tax (~\$2,030/week)

****Working pattern (when working):**** 3 days WFH, 2 office. Officially 9–5. Real core work hours: maybe 11–2. Currently on ****forced leave**** (six weeks, until mid-June 2026) because annual leave balance hit the cap. Director in Sydney, met twice. KPIs unfalsifiable.

****Guilt level:**** Persistent, low-grade. Managed by aggressive generosity and doing the work properly when it matters.

Properties

****PPOR — 92 Lakeside Circuit****

- Bought Feb 2024 for \$1.35m (rolled equity from West Dubbo sale ~\$780k)
- Current value \$1.65m+
- Mortgage ~\$780k remaining @ 6.1% → ~\$5,100/month
- 4 bed, 3 bath, 3 car, pool, study, rumpus, 1,032m²

****Investment — 26 Glenshee Close****

- Bought Nov 2020 for \$510k
- Current value \$750k

- Mortgage ~\$340k → ~\$2,250/month
- Rent \$620/week (\$2,690/month) — currently vacant from late April 2026
- Cashflow ~neutral when tenanted

Monthly Budget

Category	Amount
PPOR mortgage	\$5,100
Rates, insurance, water (PPOR)	\$480
Investment shortfall (own portion)	\$200
Utilities (electricity, gas, internet)	\$380
Groceries	\$700
Fuel (private use, ute)	\$180
Bast (food + vet sinking fund)	\$80
Streaming, subscriptions	\$90
Eating out, coffee	\$400
Hobbies (D&D, books, minis)	\$300
Tithe / charity	\$700
Personal (clothes, haircuts)	\$200
Travel sinking fund	\$400
Generosity / shouts (table, friends)	\$300
Spend	**~\$9,510**
Take-home	**~\$8,800**

Slightly over each month — dips into buffer by ~\$700–1,000. Knows. Considers it the cost of not being miserable. Doesn't tighten because the surplus from rent + bonuses + lower months balances out.

****Savings / Net position:****

- Offset against PPOR: \$42,000
- ETF portfolio (VAS/VGS, monthly DCA): \$185,000
- Emergency fund (HISA): \$25,000
- Super: \$310,000
- ****Net worth ~\$1.05m**** (after mortgages)

Daily Schedule — forced leave (current)

Time	Activity
7:00	Wake. Coffee. Bible + journal. Bast on lap.
8:00	30-min walk along the river path
8:45	Breakfast (oats, fruit, no dairy)
9:30	Reading / writing block — currently a Stoic-Christian devotional + a Kingkiller reread
11:00	D&D prep, worldbuilding, mini painting, or side projects
12:30	Lunch (usually solo)
13:30	Errands, gym (Plus Fitness Dubbo), home admin
15:00	Open block — coffee with Marcus or Ben, call Lucas, swim, garden

17:30	Dinner (cooks 4 nights, eats out 2, leftovers 1)
19:00	Reading, light gaming, hosting, TV
22:00	Wind-down: shower, no screens, journal
22:45	Sleep

Daily Schedule — working weeks

Time	Activity
6:30	Wake, coffee, Bible, walk
8:30	Breakfast, settle in
9:00	Emails, "stakeholder mapping"
11:00	Real work block (quarterly report, comms)
12:30	Long lunch (90 min, no one counts)
14:00	Calls, half-meetings, drive somewhere if bored
16:00	Wrap up
17:00	Gym or home
18:30	Dinner
20:00	Hobbies, reading, D&D prep
22:30	Sleep

Weekly Rhythm

- **Mon:** WFH. Quiet start.
- **Tue:** Dubbo office. Lunch with a colleague.
- **Wed:** WFH or fortnightly regional drive (Wellington, Narromine, Mudgee).
- **Thu:** Office.
- **Fri:** WFH technically. Light day.
- **Sat:** D&D 1:00–4:30pm at the gaming store on Macquarie. Dinner often follows.
- **Sun:** Church 10am. Slow lunch. Reading. Lucas call every second Sunday.

Social Circle

Inner ring

- **Marcus** — DM, 38, IT manager, married with two kids. Josh is godfather to one. Best mate in Dubbo.
- **Ben** — 32, vet at Macquarie Vet, single, quiet, deep friendship.
- **Talia** — 29, primary school teacher, partnered. Sharp humour. Will call Josh on his shit.
- **Naomi** — 35, paralegal, divorced no kids. Most worldly at the table; surprising warmth.
- **Lucas** — back in Bendigo, fortnightly Sunday call. 15-year friendship.

Middle ring: church people (half a dozen names), work colleagues (pleasant, not deep), gym regulars (nodding only), two old La Trobe mates (annual catch-up).

Outer ring: parents in Bendigo (fortnightly call), sister (monthly).

D&D Status

- **Campaign:** Storm King's Thunder, run by Marcus, started 7 March 2026
- **Slot:** Saturdays 1:00–4:30pm
- **Sessions played:** 8 (current)
- **Character:** Alphie J. Roane, human Divination Wizard
- **Special NPC:** Lifferlas (the awakened tree at Goldenfields)
- **Current IG state:** Northfurrow's End, Goldenfields, late night, asleep after the apology to Wren
- **Table-side projects:** painted minis collection (~40 figures), small terrain set, custom dice from forced-leave online buying spree

The Manifesto

1. The job is not the point. The salary is a gift, not an identity. Don't perform busyness to earn it. Do the work well when it matters. Don't pretend it's harder than it is.

2. Generosity offsets guilt — and is also just good. If the role pays absurdly for what it asks, redirect the surplus. Tithe properly. Shout the table. Cover Ben's books without making it a thing. This isn't moral arithmetic; it's just how money should move.

3. Single is a season, not a deficiency. Don't wait. Don't pine. Don't rush. Live the life now. If a partner comes, let them join a life that's already running.

4. Body before brain. Walk, swim, lift, sleep. The headaches and chest tension are loneliness and inactivity wearing different costumes. Move daily. Sleep before midnight.

5. House is for hosting, not flexing. The pool, spa, pool table, four bedrooms — tools for community, not status. The house earns its keep when it's full.

6. Faith stays first, even quieter. No family rhythm to carry it, so it has to be chosen weekly. Don't drift. Sundays matter. The journal stays.

7. Hobbies are not productivity. D&D, reading, painting, worldbuilding — not "side projects." Don't monetise. Don't optimise. Let them be useless and good.

8. Friendship is the long game. Marcus, Ben, Lucas — 20-year friendships in the making. Show up. Reply. Drive over.

9. Don't let comfort kill curiosity. The job is easy, the house is nice, the danger is going dim. Read hard things. Have hard conversations. Travel somewhere uncomfortable once a year.

10. Be honest about loneliness. It's the real cost of this life. Not denied, not over-corrected for. Named, sat with, and not used as an excuse to make bad decisions.

The Handbook

Hosting

- House open to the D&D table any time with 24 hrs notice

- Spare rooms always made up
- Stocked: NA beer, real beer, wine, snacks, good coffee
- No one drives home if drinking — couches, beds, lifts in the morning
- One open-house dinner per fortnight is the goal

****Money****

- Tithe 10% off the top, monthly, on payday
- DCA \$2,500/month into ETFs
- Offset gets any surplus
- Emergency fund is for emergencies — boredom isn't one
- One major discretionary buy per quarter, two-week wait before pulling trigger

****Time****

- One unscheduled day per week minimum
- No work email on phone
- Phone in kitchen drawer after 9pm
- Sabbath: Sunday afternoon to Monday morning

****People****

- Reply to texts within 24 hrs
- No ghosting, even when conversations get hard
- One deep call per week minimum (Lucas, Marcus, family)
- Say yes to invitations by default unless there's a real reason not to

****Health****

- Walk daily, non-negotiable
- Lift 3x/week
- GP every 6 months
- Therapy fortnightly (Dr K, Dubbo) — keep going even when "fine"
- Caffeine cut-off: 11am
- No dairy

****Renting Glenshee Close****

- Long-term tenants preferred
- Rent slightly under market for stable tenants
- Fix things fast when reported
- If a friend wants it: talk it through carefully before mixing housing and friendship — and do it through the agent regardless

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